Group discussion is when a group of people comes together to discuss a certain topic. This also allows people to walk around a concept in greater detail and learn the topic in depth. This practice is also being applied during campus interviews and selection process.

A group discussion among students is being organized to see and evaluate their thinking skills, listening abilities and This also allows people to walk around a concept in greater detail and learn the topic in depth. This practice is also being applied during campus interviews and selection process.

One should learn to control the conversation through listening attentively and then having the perseverance to mould it towards his/her own direction.

Group Discussion serves several purposes:

- Collecting data
- Breeding fresh ideas and taking inputs from a particular group
- Perception of common people on a particular topic
- Identify a solution to a specific problem or issue
- Selecting candidates after their written test for hiring in a company
- Selecting candidates for admission in an educational institute

Benefits of Group Discussions

- It is a good way to engage the participants in a fruitful discussion
- Group discussion generates a creative thinking in all participants, something beyond the obvious answers and solution to a specific problem
- Generate more ideas and a structured presentation of a topic
- Improves analytical abilities to think on a particular given topic
- Enables profound and in-depth understanding of the subject
- Provides different approaches to a topic
- Helps to come to a concluding point or at least near solution to a problem
- Gives a chance to listen, know and understand diverse opinions on a particular matter
- Improves confidence in public speaking platform
- Can alter our perspectives as well

Areas of Evaluation in a Selection GD

Though a group discussion, many things for a particular candidate can be assessed, such as his/her mental capacity to think, his creative bent of mind, Analytical abilities, comprehending a subject and then speaking on it, awareness, attitude, and energy levels. Some of them are detailed below:

- **Understanding of the Subject:** During a group discussion, it is being constantly assessed how deep your knowledge is about the chosen topic and how well you are aware of each aspect of that topic.
- **Assertiveness:** You confidence shows up in a group discussion. It is assessed that how confident you are while putting up your opinion in front of other. Others may certainly vary or disagree to the point but how well and how confidently you bring your thoughts forward is what matters the most.
- **Team Work:** While working in an organization or even during management studies, it is very important to work as a part of the team in a given project or any assignment. This skill is

really important and it is evaluated through GD as well. You not only put your own points but also listen to others and then come to a concluding point. This shows how ready you are to listen to other's opinion, give value to that and also at the same time stand by your own convictions.

- **Willingness to Take the Initiative:** This skill plays a very important part in professional and personal life. Employers highly regard it. They want that you just do not stick to your own work but also should be able to take extra initiative whenever it is required. When you start a topic, you have to be very cautious so as to put the right point forward and give the entire discussion a right direction.
- **Listening Skills:** This is again an important skill which gets evaluated during a group discussion. So, you should learn to listen not to reply back, but pay full attention to what the other person is trying to say. Generally, people get biased to their own thoughts and ideas and do not want to look beyond that. So listening to other person is also essential.
- **Adaptability:** In today's dynamic and ever-changing environment, it is essential to keep yourself flexible and adaptable toward the situation. During a group discussion, sometimes you need to agree to some point and also it happens that in due course some views change your mind as well. So being rigid and stubborn is not going to be very helpful
- **Leadership Qualities:** Group discussion demonstrates clearly who amongst them is taking the lead and who is a passive contestant. A good leader gives the entire discussion a good direction and takes it forward whenever it is deviating from the main topic. But while taking the lead, one has to be double sure whether his/her points are valid or not, else it will give the other person a golden opportunity to snatch the lead away and negate his/her points.
- **Communication Skills:** As communication is a medium of expressing your thought, it is more important in today's interactive world. Hence communication skills are yet again important skills which are evaluated through a structured group discussion.

Dos and Don'ts of participating in Group Discussion

As you have to participate in a Group Discussion. several questions spring across your mind. You want to know what actions and gestures can get you positive points and what can cost you the selection. Here's a list of Dos and Don'ts of participating in the GD.

Dos of participating in a GD:

- Listen to the subject carefully
- Put down your thoughts on a paper
- Initiate the discussion if you know the subject well
- Listen to others if you don't know the subject
- Support you point with some facts and figures
- Make short contribution of 25-30 seconds 3-4 times
- Give others a chance to speak
- Speak politely and pleasantly. Respect contribution from other members.
- Disagree politely and agree with what is right.
- Summarize the discussion if the group has not reached a conclusion.

Don'ts of participating in a Group Discussion

- Initiate the discussion if you do not have sufficient knowledge about the given topic.
- Over speak, intervene and snatch other's chance to speak.
- Argue and shout during the GD
- Look at the evaluators or a particular group member
- Talk irrelevant things and distract the discussion
- Pose negative body gestures like touching the nose, leaning back on the chair, knocking the table with a pen etc.
- Mention erratic statistics.
- Display low self confidence with shaky voice and trembling hands.
- Try to dominate the discussion
- Put others in an embarrassing situation by asking them to speak if they don't want.

Teamwork is "the process of working collaboratively with a group of people in order to achieve a goal".

Team-building is "the ability to identify and motivate individual employees to form a team that stays together, works together, and achieves together"

These 3 C's of teamwork—communication, collaboration, and coordination—are the pillars of successful teamwork. By fostering these skills within your team, you can create a cohesive and high-performing group capable of overcoming challenges, innovating, and achieving its goals.

What are the six key areas of team building?

The six elements are role clarity, trust, job satisfaction, commitment to the organization, motivation and empowerment. If you look at any person in your team, you can describe your relationship with him or her looking at: Role clarity: How clear it is to this person what behaviors and tasks you expect.

What is team working?

Team working is collaborating within a group to achieve common goals. Also known as teamwork, team working refers to the methods teams use to meet their objectives. When teams strategize well, they may accomplish more together than they could independently.

Team working has an important role in organizations because many businesses rely on members of certain departments, such as marketing or accounting, to use their individual skills and

knowledge to work toward the same goals. Teams that work well together have many features in common, such as:

- Clear responsibilities
- Open communication between members
- Minimal competition
- Inclusiveness in decision-making
- Support and respect for one another
- Accountability for roles and actions

What is team building?

Team building is the creation of a team selected based on the members' individual skills and their ability to complement each other to create positive outcomes. It also involves engaging these team members in activities that increase their cohesiveness by teaching them to balance each other's skills.

Team building has an important role in the workplace because it functions as the first step toward team working. Examples of team-building activities include office games, community service and company outings.

Team building vs. team working

Team building and team working involve different aims, but they have similarities as well. Both activities help members within an organization reach specific goals, they just do it differently. Here are some similarities and differences between team building and team working:

Purpose

The purpose of team building is to create a team so that teamwork can take place. It allows organizations to develop diverse teams made up of members who can work together toward the same goals in different ways. Team-building activities serve the purpose of bringing team members together and boosting morale to increase motivation.

Team working takes place once team building has already occurred. Once an organization establishes a team, members discuss solutions to current challenges and how each one can help. They then complete their own tasks independently, so their combined outcomes have a positive effect on the team and the company.

Structure

The structure of a company's team-building exercises determines the structure of the assembled team. Activities companies use to build teams vary based on their primary goals.

For example, if they want to emphasize compassion and helpfulness, they may structure their team-building efforts around community service projects. If they choose critical thinking as the primary focus, it might work better to create the type of team they want.

Team working structure depends on the results of the team-building exercises, why the organization created the team and the dynamics of the members. Some structures are organic or flat, with flexible roles that may overlap. Mechanistic structures have an established hierarchy with few leaders and defined positions.

Strategy

The strategy for team building centers on developing a team that works together successfully. Steps organizations can take to build strong teams include:

1. Define the team's purpose.
2. Assemble a team based on necessary roles.
3. Build trust among team members.
4. Be clear about expectations.
5. Evaluate performance regularly.
6. Provide constructive feedback.

Ensuring a solid foundation for a team involves creating teamwork strategies that encourage team members to work together productively. Ways teams can improve team working skills include:

- Encouraging listening and communication
- Embracing diversity among team members
- Making consensus-based decisions
- Solving problems as a team
- Pairing new members with others who can help them get comfortable
- Keeping in mind the team's most urgent priorities
- Making accomplishing goals fun

Collaboration between members is important in both team building and team working. To encourage collaboration during team working, organizations provide their teams with resources they can use to brainstorm, share and expand on ideas.

Many companies use digital resources to help teams collaborate effectively. These may include video conferencing and messaging programs, work management software and cloud-based productivity tools.

To encourage collaboration when building a team, organizations consider the roles the team needs to reach its goals.

Objectives

Team working and team building objectives are different, and each relates to their purpose. The objectives of team building emphasize the interconnection between team members. They include communication, engagement, trust and bonding.

Team working objectives focus on how well the team meets goals. They vary by team, but organizations typically have similar frameworks for measuring efficacy. They may include factors such as:

- Productivity
- Participation
- Job satisfaction
- Retention
- Conflict resolution
- Goal completion

Outcomes

Despite their major differences, team building and team working have a similar outcome: to improve personal and company growth through team efforts. Building a successful team leads to a functional team, and a functional team accomplishes goals that benefit its members, the team and the organization.

Managers focus on managing work and output; leaders focus on the people and leading them to achieve overall objectives. A manager's role and approach can be thought of as more transactional - they tell employees what they need to achieve and expect them to do their assigned duties.

What’s the Difference Between Leaders and Managers?

Leaders and managers share some essential characteristics; however, many dissimilarities make them distinct. While leadership is about building a vision for people to follow, management is looking after the day-to-day operations of a business. So, here are some more differences between leaders and managers.

LEADER	MANAGER
Leaders have missions to accomplish	Managers are goal-oriented
Leaders challenge the status	Managers maintain or try to

quo	achieve the status quo
Leaders are unique	Managers mimic their competitors
Leaders take risk	Managers avoid taking risk
Leaders are willing to learn and grow personally	Managers perfect existing, proven skills
Leaders build relationships	Managers focus on goals and objectives
Leaders coach people to become a better version of themselves	Managers direct people to achieve the company goal
Results of leadership are intangible	Results of management is measurable
Leadership is qualitative	Management is quantitative
Leaders have fans	Managers have employees

What Are the Traits a Leader Possesses?

Leaders are individuals who may not possess or display power; instead, they would use human assistance to accomplish a goal. A great leader is someone who can do this day after day, and year after year, under any circumstance.

Here are some of the effective **leadership skills** and personality traits every leader must imbibe to become successful:

1. Passionate: Leaders are people with a plan. They have their eyes set on the goal and therefore work hard towards achieving them. They also motivate others to achieve their goals by guiding and directing them.

2. Virtuous: A good leader should be transparent with his people because honesty reduces miscommunication and internal feuds in the team.

3. Empathetic: A leader should be an empathetic being as it will help them in developing a strong bond with their team. Furthermore, being empathetic toward others will help a leader to address and solve the problems and complaints of their team members.

4. Communication skills: Leaders possess great communication skills. They are transparent with their team and share failures and successes with them.

5. Open-mindedness and creativity: A good leader is someone who is open to new ideas and accepting of other people's perspectives. Being a good and

effective leader means understanding that there is no right way to do things. Therefore, a good leader is always ready to listen, observe, and be willing to change. They are also out-of-the-box thinkers and encourage their team to do so.

What Are the Traits a Manager Must Possess?

A manager is the backbone of any business. They are responsible for the smooth functioning of the business. A manager's responsibility ranges from monitoring day-to-day business activities to scouting human resources. To undertake these difficult tasks, a manager must possess some unique personality traits. Here are some of the effective management skills and personality traits of a successful manager.

1. Control: A manager is responsible for monitoring daily business transactions. So, they need to be controlled to ensure desired results.

2. Team-oriented: A good manager must address the issues of his team. He should motivate them to do their best in any circumstances. They must implement the right work ethic and culture in the team and ensure everyone follows it.

3. Good communicator: A good manager must strive to become a good communicator. Managers are the key between top-level management and low-level management; therefore, they need good interpersonal skills to avoid conflict in the company.

4. Dependable: A manager should be easy-going and dependable; this characteristic allows employees to trust and depend on you.

5. Process management: Managers are responsible for introducing the right work culture and ethics in the company. Therefore, a manager must be someone who has a clear vision and understands the goals of an organization.

Though there is no litmus test to determine if someone is a manager or leader, however, a few differences between an effective leader's and a manager's personality traits mentioned above make the line of distinction between them clearer. Now, let's move to the ways in which the effectiveness of leadership and management can be measured and understood.

How to Develop Leadership and Management Skills?

There are various methods for honing management and leading abilities.

One method is to look for formal education and training programs, such as management development programs or business courses.

Another method is to participate in volunteer work, internships, or projects as a leader to gain real-world experience.

It can also be helpful to find areas for improvement by asking for feedback from mentors, peers, and colleagues.

Developing self-awareness and emotional intelligence can also improve leadership and management abilities.

Keeping up with industry trends and networking with other pros can also present chances to pick up new insights and learn from others.

Practice, feedback, and continuous learning are essential to developing effective leadership and management skills.

Decision making is the process of making choices by identifying a decision, gathering information, and assessing alternative resolutions. Using a step-by-step decision-making process can help you make more deliberate, thoughtful decisions by organizing relevant information and defining alternatives.

Defining the business decision-making process

The business decision-making process is a step-by-step process allowing professionals to solve problems by weighing evidence, examining alternatives, and choosing a path from there. This defined

process also provides an opportunity, at the end, to review whether the decision was the right one.

7 decision-making process steps

Though there are many slight variations of the decision-making framework floating around on the Internet, in business textbooks, and in leadership presentations, professionals most commonly use these seven steps.

1. Identify the decision

To make a decision, you must first identify the problem you need to solve or the question you need to answer. Clearly define your decision. If you misidentify the problem to solve, or if the problem you've chosen is too broad, you'll knock the decision train off the track before it even leaves the station.

If you need to achieve a specific goal from your decision, make it measurable and timely.

2. Gather relevant information

Once you have identified your decision, it's time to gather the information relevant to that choice. Do an internal assessment, seeing where your organization has succeeded and failed in areas related to your decision. Also, seek information from external sources, including studies, market research, and, in some cases, evaluation from paid consultants.

Keep in mind, you can become bogged down by too much information and that might only complicate the process.

3. Identify the alternatives

With relevant information now at your fingertips, identify possible solutions to your problem. There is usually more than one option to consider when trying to meet a goal. For example, if your company is trying to gain more engagement on social media, your alternatives could include paid social advertisements, a change in your organic social media strategy, or a combination of the two.

4. Weigh the evidence

Once you have identified multiple alternatives, weigh the evidence for or against said alternatives. See what companies have done in the past to succeed in these areas, and take a good look at your organization's own wins and losses. Identify potential pitfalls for each of your alternatives, and weigh those against the possible rewards.

5. Choose among alternatives

Here is the part of the decision-making process where you actually make the decision. Hopefully, you've identified and clarified what decision needs to be made, gathered all relevant information, and developed and considered the potential paths to take. You should be prepared to choose.

6. Take action

Once you've made your decision, act on it! Develop a plan to make your decision tangible and achievable. Develop a project plan related to your decision, and then assign tasks to your team.

7. Review your decision

After a predetermined amount of time—which you defined in step one of the decision-making process—take an honest look back at your decision. Did you solve the problem? Did you answer the question? Did you meet your goals?

If so, take note of what worked for future reference. If not, learn from your mistakes as you begin the decision-making process again.

Stress and Time Management

Some stress can be healthy because it can encourage you to find a new skill, get things done or do something well. But stress that goes on for a long time can negatively impact all aspects of your health. Being able to manage time and, in turn, stress, is essential for a healthy body and mind. Here's how to do it.

Learn to Say 'No'

Unless taking responsibility for a specific task is truly important to you (or to your boss), learn to say "no" to tasks that you feel pressured to do. Instead, focus on activities that you enjoy and that will enhance your career and personal development.

Organize a Realistic Schedule

Plan your schedule before your week starts and make sure all the tasks you include are realistic. Don't strive for perfection. Instead, strive for excellence and don't worry about things that you simply can't take on or control.

In addition to your work or class schedule, as well as shopping, laundry, errands and cooking, a realistic and health-promoting schedule should include the following:

- **Exercise.** Thirty to sixty minutes of exercise each day helps reduce stress and promotes numerous health benefits. To save time and be efficient with exercise, set an alarm and go with a friend or family member. Keep your gym clothes wherever you are (car, office) and make sure to have your gear ready the night before.
- **Relaxation.** To ease stress, try belly breathing: slow, deep breaths through your nose that fill the stomach, not chest. Do this technique sitting or standing; try it when riding in a car or waiting in line.
- **Sleep.** Do you find it difficult to get out of bed? Do you have a hard time remembering things and concentrating at work or school? Do you fall asleep the moment your head hits the pillow? If so, you might be sleeping too little. Try adding 15 minutes to your

sleep schedule each night until you find the amount that keeps you energized the whole day. Most people need 8 to 9 hours of sleep each night.

- **Laughter.** Laughter reduces stress, boosts your immune system, decreases blood pressure and improves mood. Add laughter to your day by calling a friend or family member who typically makes you laugh, watching a funny movie or video, or inviting friends over for game night.

Create a Prioritized To-Do List

Create your list at the beginning of each day and note which items are the most important and which ones you can put off. Number items by priority, or use color-coding: red for “do this right away,” orange for “do this next,” yellow for “do this last.”

Combine Tasks

Combine tasks and errands for time efficiency. For example, when making a meal for yourself, make more than one serving; eat one serving now and save the rest for later. Also, when planning your day or even your week, determine what errands you have to run and figure out which ones you can combine into one trip.

Plan Ahead

Think about what you have to accomplish in the near future, and come up with an action plan to guide you through the workload with minimal stress. Don’t let important tasks build up because they’ll be more stressful to handle in a time-crunched situation.

Eliminate Time-Wasting Activities and Procrastination

Limit time you spend watching shows and videos and surfing the internet. Finish an important task first and then do something to reward yourself. Try to work in intervals: work for 60 to 90 minutes and then take a 10-minute break.

Keep a Time Log

How much time do you actually spend on accomplishing important tasks? How much time do you spend on time-wasting activities? Once you figure out that ratio, try to change your habits to match a more productive — and therefore less stressful — lifestyle.

General Stress-Reducing Tips

- Think about and be grateful for the good things in your life.
- Expect positive outcomes in new situations.

- When you realize you’re stressed, take a 10-minute break to do something you enjoy.
- Take care of your body and mind: eat healthy food, drink enough water each day, exercise enough, sleep well, relax and laugh often.